

Zodiacal divisions

The zodiac can be divided not only into signs but also into decans, dodecatemoria and bounds. All these divisions date back to the early period of horoscopy.

Decan, dodecatemorium and bound

A decan spans 10 degrees, a dodecatemorium covers 2.5 degrees and a bound has a variable number of degrees.

A decan is also often referred to as a 'decanate', a dodecatemorium as a 'dwad' and a bound as a 'term'.

Decans

For decans there are two variants: a division by signs and a division by planets.

The division by signs assigns the first 10 degrees of a sign to the sign itself, the next 10 degrees to the next sign in the same element, and the last 10 degrees to the sign after that in the same element. For Leo, for example, the decans are successively Leo, Sagittarius and Aries.

The division by planets starts at the first decan of Aries, which is assigned to the planet Mars. For the following decans, the Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, Saturn and Jupiter are assigned in succession. The sequence is then repeated.

When the decans are arranged by planets, the last decan of Pisces falls under Mars, as does the first decan of Aries.

Dodecatemoria

A dodecatemorium closely resembles the 12th harmonic. Each sign is divided into twelve parts of 2.5 degrees each. The difference with harmonics is that the first dodecatemorium is assigned to the sign itself. For the sign Taurus, for example, the first 2.5 degrees are assigned to Taurus, the next 2.5 degrees to Gemini, and so on.

There is also a variant described by Paulus of Alexandria (4th century CE). Paulus multiplies the longitude by 12. If the result exceeds 360 degrees, those 360 degrees are subtracted again. This method corresponds to the 12th harmonic.

Bounds

The bounds divide each sign into 5 unequal parts. Ptolemy is the primary source for these.

In Enigma you will find two variants: the Egyptian terms and the terms according to Ptolemy. The Egyptian terms are the oldest. Ptolemy was critical of the Egyptian terms and introduced his own variant.



1. Ennis, Stephanie Jean - *Decanates and Dwads*. Tempe Az., 1983.
2. Gundel, Wilhelm - *Dekane und Dekansternbilder: Ein Beitrag zur Geschichte der Sternbilder der KulturVölker*. Hamburg, 1936.
3. Kampherbeek, Jan - *Dodecatemoria*. Spica, vol. 6 no. 4, January 1983.
4. Ptolemy - *Tetrabiblos*, translated by F. E. Robbins. London, 1940.
5. Luyckx, Zus - *De Dwads: Zo hard als Staal. Zo Concreet als Stenen*. Dendermonde, 2021.